PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

# Vision, Roadmap & Agile Delivery

*From product vision to a prioritized, estimated Scrum backlog*

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

# What this program covers

## 01

### Foundations & Vision

Role of the PM/PO, product vision, strategy

## 02

### Know Your User

Personas, research, scenarios

## 03

### Roadmap

Outcome-based roadmapping, OKRs

## 04

### Backlog

Building, slicing (INVEST), Definition of Ready

## 05

### Prioritize & Estimate

Value, risk, story points, Planning Poker

## 06

### Scrum in Practice

Roles, events, artifacts, metrics, retrospectives

# The Product Owner / Product Manager

*Accountable for maximizing the value of the product resulting from the Scrum Team's work.*

- Develop and clearly communicate the Product Goal
- Create and communicate Product Backlog items
- Order the Product Backlog
- Ensure the Backlog is transparent, visible and understood

1

## One person, not a committee

The Product Owner may represent the needs of many stakeholders in the Product Backlog — but stakeholders who want to change the Backlog must convince the Product Owner, not bypass them.

*Source: 2020 Scrum Guide*

# Questions an effective vision answers

## 1 Who

Who is the target customer? Who are the target users?

## 2 What need

Which needs will the product address? What value does it add?

## 3 What product

Which attributes are critical to success? What will it roughly look like and do?

## 4 Vs. alternatives

How does it compare to competitor and internal products? What are the unique selling points and target price?

## 5 Business model

How will the company make money? What are the revenue sources?

## 6 Feasibility

Is the product feasible? Can the company build and sell it?

*Tool: Product Vision Board (Roman Pichler) · Video: "How to Create a Powerful Product Vision"*

# PRODUCT VISION BOARD

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## VISION

What is the reason for creating the product?
What positive change should it create?

## TARGET GROUP

Which market or market segment does the product address? Who are the target customers and users?

## NEEDS

What problem does the product solve or which benefit does it offer? If you identify several needs, prioritise them and move the most important one to the top.

## PRODUCT

What product is it? What are its three to five stand-out features that set it apart from competing offering? Is it feasible to develop the product?

## BUSINESS GOALS

How will the product benefit the company that develops and provides it? What are the desired business benefits? Prioritise them and move the most important one to the top.

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https://www.romanpichler.com/blog/the-product-vision-board/

# Personas & vision techniquesc

- **Prototypes & mock-ups**
- **Personas & scenarios**
- **Use cases & user stories**

*A persona grounds every backlog decision in a specific, memorable user — replacing “the user” with a name, goals, and context.*

*Tool: Persona Template (Roman Pichler)*

M

**Maria, 34**

Freelance Designer

GOAL

Deliver client work faster without missing details

FRUSTRATION

Juggling five tools to track one project

QUOTE

“I just want one place to see everything.”

*(illustrative example)*

# ROMAN'S PERSONA TEMPLATE

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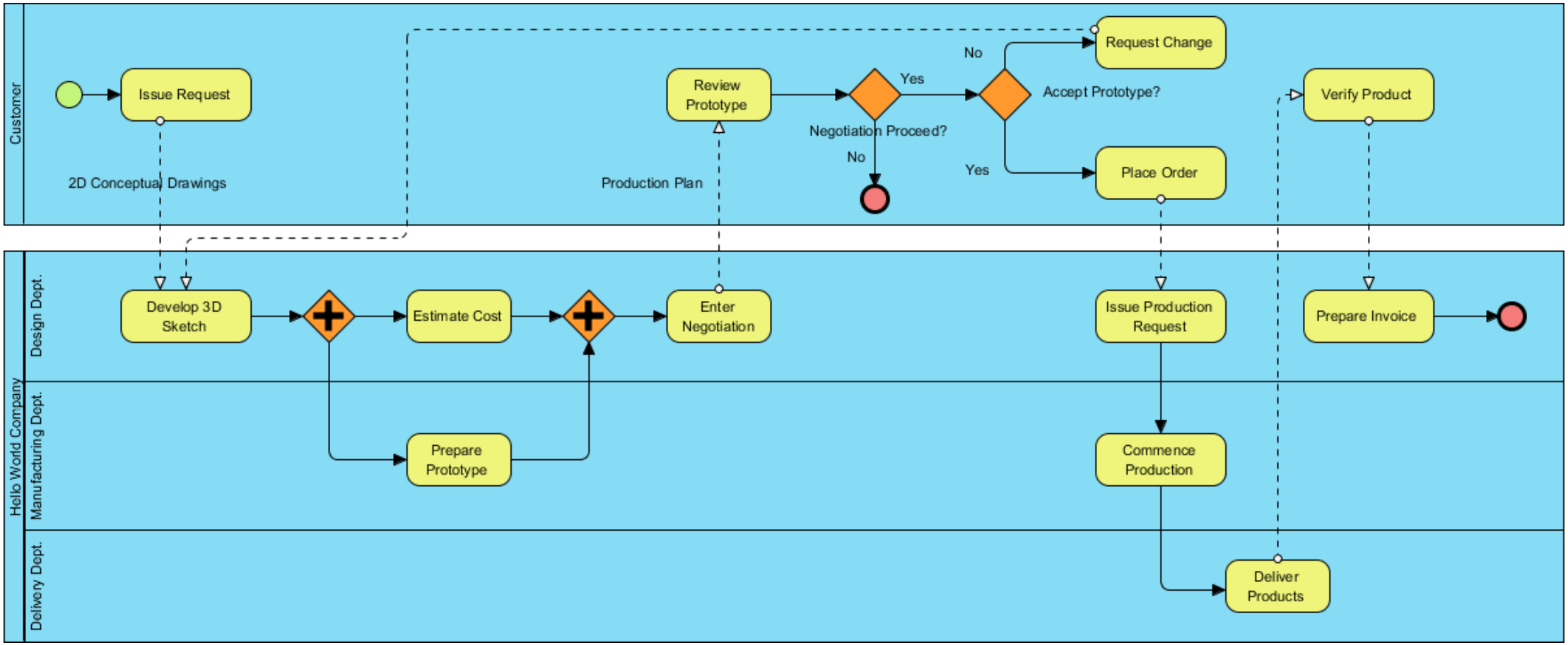
|  PICTURE & NAME |  DETAILS |  GOAL |
|---|---|---|
| What does the persona look like? How is it called? Choose a realistic and believable picture and name. | What are the persona's relevant characteristics? For instance, demographics such as age, gender, occupation, and income; psychographics including lifestyle, social class, and personality; behavioural attributes like usage patterns, attitudes, and brand loyalty. Only state details that are relevant. | What problem does the persona want to solve or which benefit does the character want to gain? Why would the persona use or buy the product? If you identify more than one goal, prioritise them and state the main goal at the top. |

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https://www.romanpichler.com/the-persona-template/

# User jouneys




https://www.cybermedian.com/mastering-bpmn-a-comprehensive-journey-through-business-process-modeling/

# The product roadmap

A living document capturing the goals of upcoming product versions — launch date, target customers/needs, and top 3–5 features per version.




*Focus on the next 6–12 months rather than predicting 2–3 years out. Outcome-based roadmaps state the problem to solve, not just the feature to ship.*

*Tool: The GO Product Roadmap (Roman Pichler) · See also: OKRs and Product Roadmaps*

# THE GO PRODUCT ROADMAP

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| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **DATE**<br>The date or time frame when a goal should be met. | | | | |
| **NAME**<br>The name of the new release. | | | | |
| **GOAL**<br>The outcome or benefit you want to achieve. | | | | |
| **FEATURES**<br>The high-level features required to meet the goal. | | | | |
| **METRICS**<br>The measures to determine if the goal has been met. | | | | |

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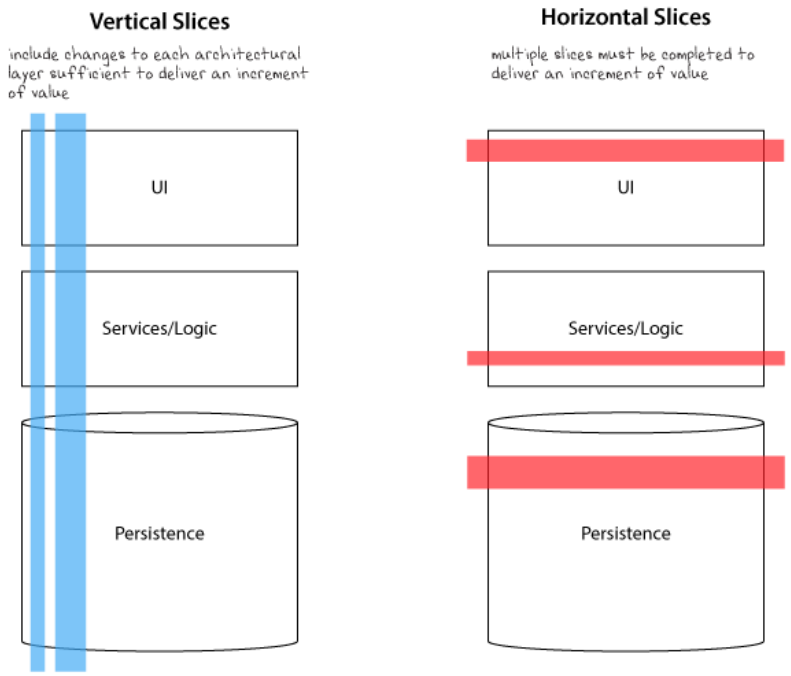
https://www.romanpichler.com/tools/the-go-product-roadmap/

# Slicing user stories: INVEST

| I | N | V | E | S | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Independent** | **Negotiable** | **Valuable** | **Estimable** | **Small** | **Testable** |
| Stories don't depend on one another | Details are open to discussion | Customer value + team learning value | The team can size it | Feel progress during the sprint | Clear acceptance criteria |

*Give special attention to "Small" so the team can feel progress during the sprint. Source: Humanizing Work — Guide to Splitting User Stories*

# HOW TO SLICE




**INVEST in your User Stories**

**I**ndependent

**N**egotiable

**V**aluable

**E**stimable

**S**mall

**T**estable

Value = customer value + team learning value

Give special attention to “small” so you can feel progress during the sprint

https://www.humanizingwork.com/the-humanizing-work-guide-to-splitting-user-stories/

# Definition of Ready (DoR)

*“Can we start working on this?” A checklist for the team, by the team — every backlog item in the sprint must adhere to it.*

- [ ] Is it clear what is to be done?
- [ ] Do we know all the business rules?
- [ ] Are dependencies cleared out?
- [ ] Do we have all the acceptance criteria?
- [ ] Do we have a test plan and test cases?

## Why it matters

A shared Definition of Ready prevents the team from pulling in stories that stall mid-sprint — protecting both velocity and morale. It pairs with the Definition of Done to bookend the delivery process.

# Four factors that drive priority

1

**Value**

Is the item necessary for bringing the product to life? Could the product still succeed without it?

2

**Knowledge, uncertainty & risk**

Risky, uncertain items go first — a risk-driven approach surfaces early failure.

3

**Releasability**

Each release should provide useful functionality and generate feedback.

4

**Dependencies**

Resolve them where possible; combine or re-split dependent stories.

# Story points: relative sizing

Story points are coarse-grained, relative measures of effort and size — not hours. An item worth one point is half the size of a two-point item.

*Because points are relative and arbitrary, they cannot be compared across teams unless those teams share a common range with common semantics.*




*Fibonacci-like scale used in Planning Poker*

## Two levels of estimate

### Coarse-grained

Product Backlog items — rough size, in story points.

### Fine-grained

Sprint Backlog tasks — usually stated in hours.

*Rule: only the people who build the increment estimate. The Product Owner and Scrum Master do not estimate, and do not influence estimates.*

# Roles, events & artifacts

## Roles

- Product Owner
- Scrum Master
- Developers

## Events

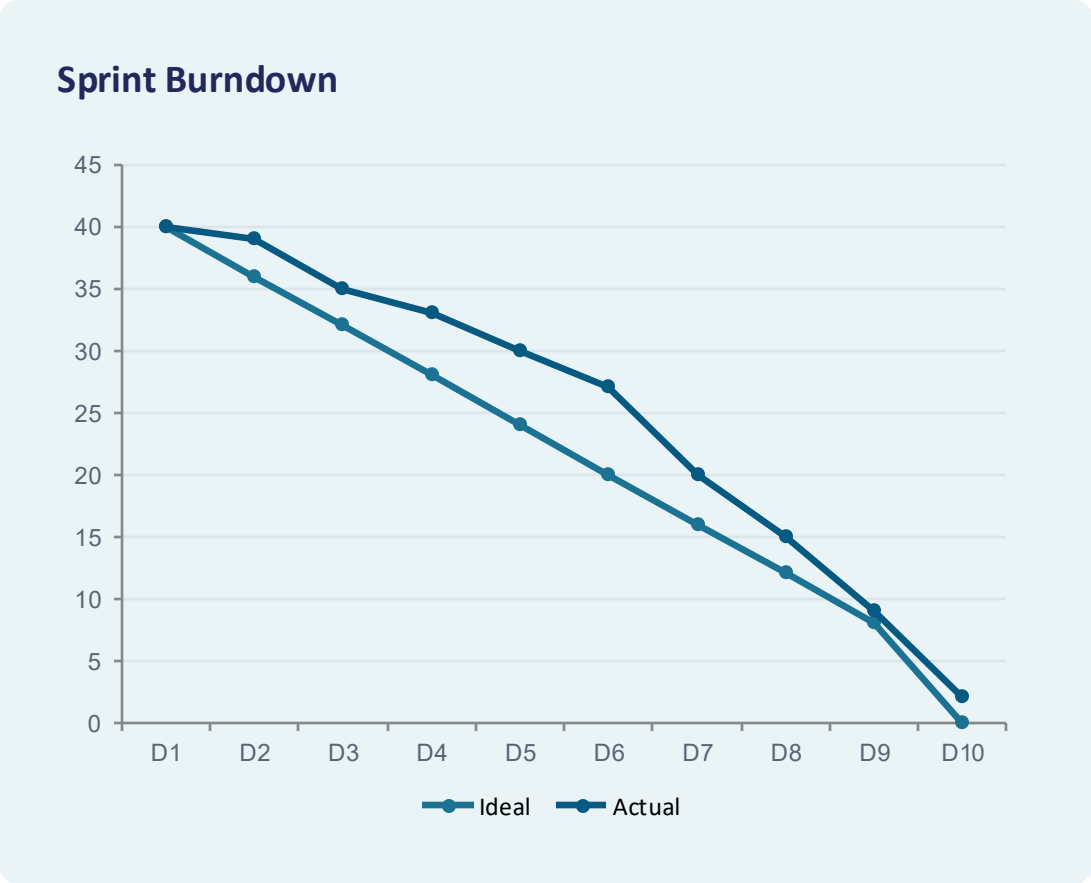
- Sprint Planning
- Daily Scrum
- Sprint Review
- Sprint Retrospective

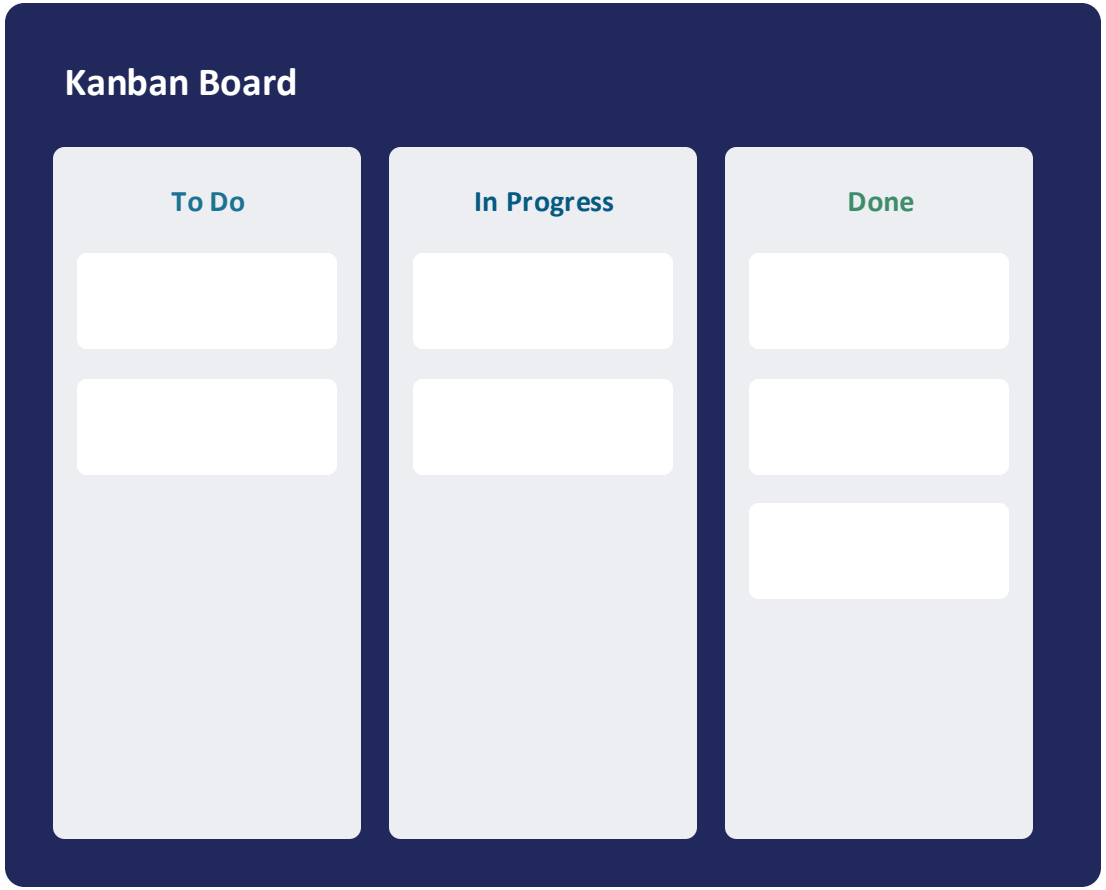
## Artifacts

- Product Backlog
- Sprint Backlog
- Increment

*Source: The 2020 Scrum Guide — scrumguides.org*

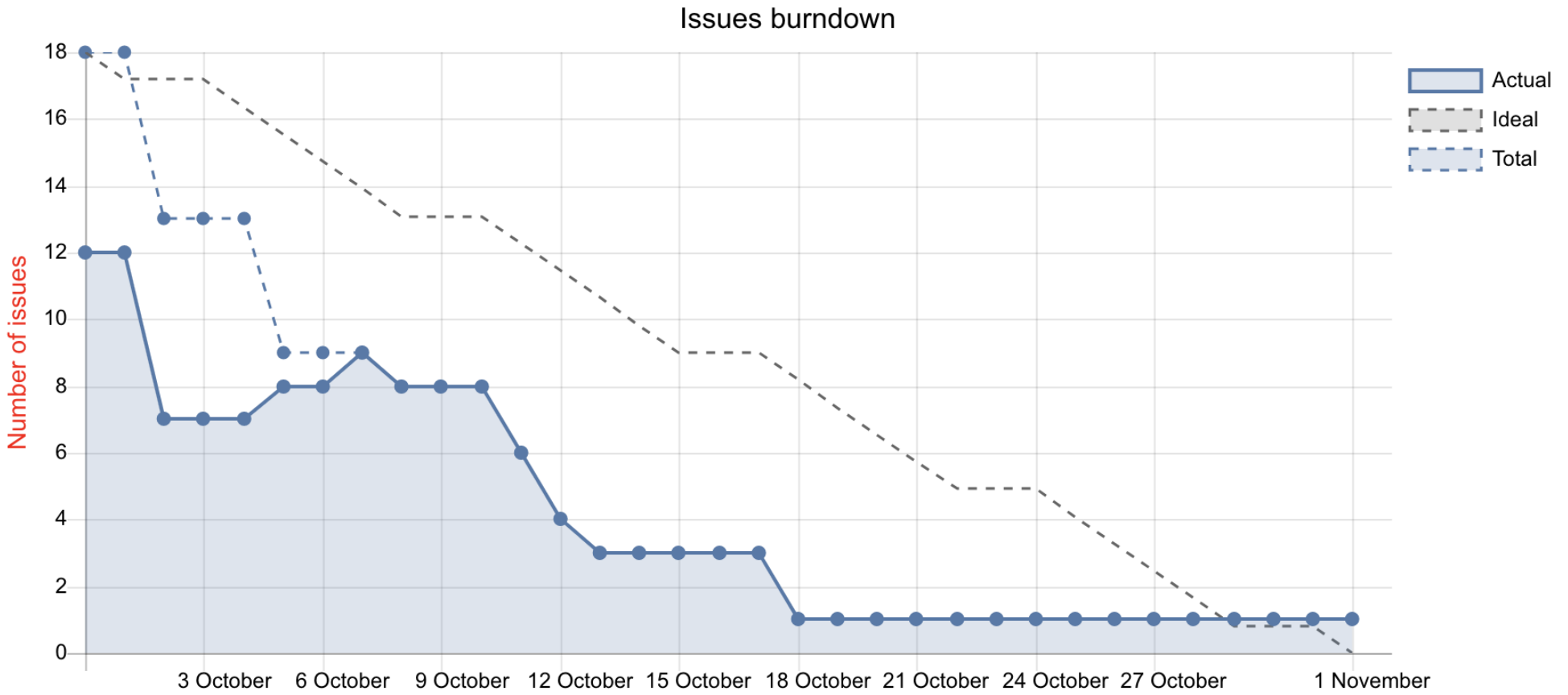
# Making progress visible



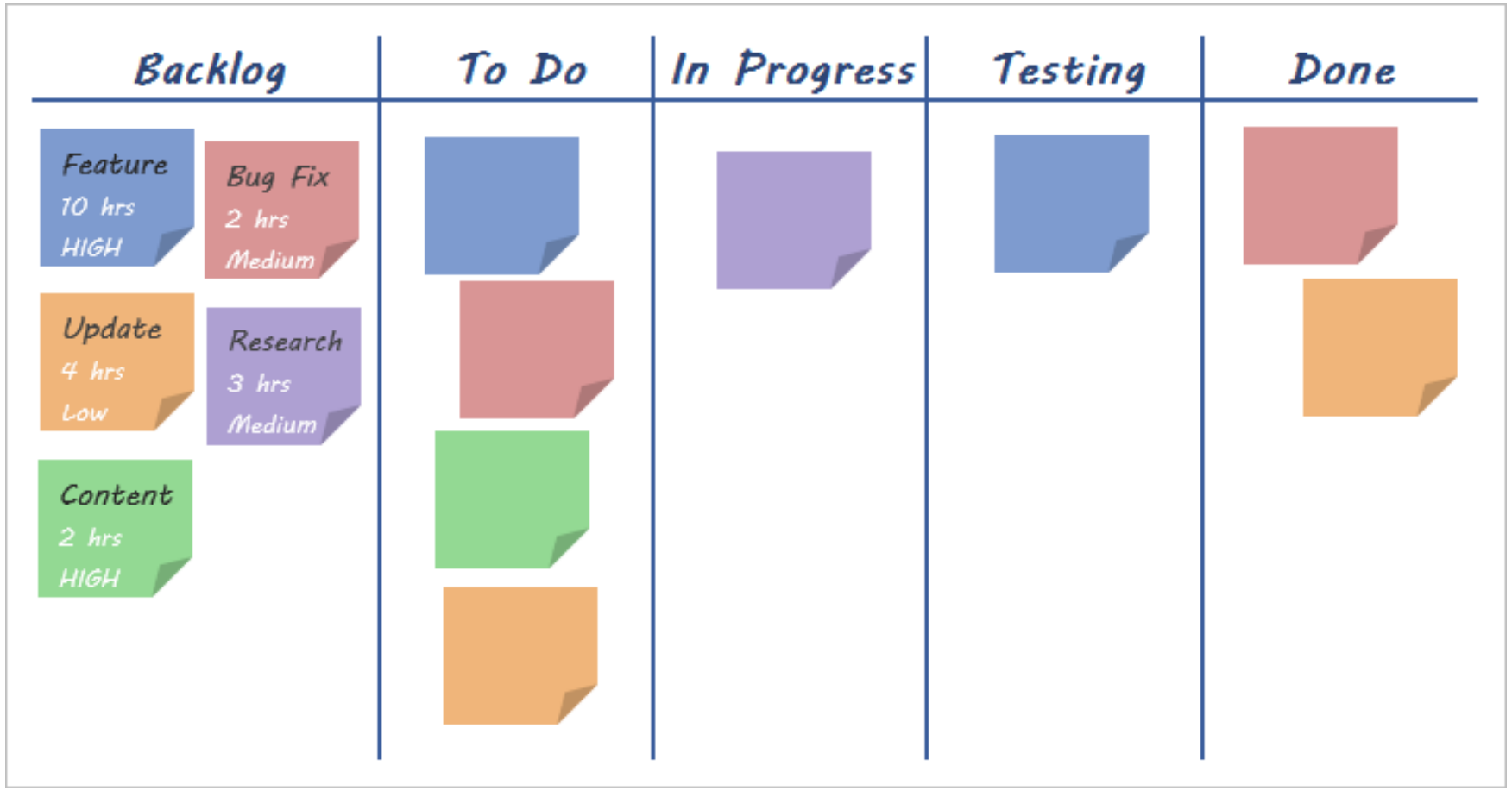

*Metrics evidence progress and surface risk to the sprint early — they are not just reporting overhead.*

# BURNDOWN CHART




https://plan.io/blog/burndown-chart-and-agile-metrics/

# KANBAN BOARD




https://www.vertex42.com/ExcelTemplates/agile-kanban-board.html

# Definition of Done & Retrospectives

## Definition of Done

*"Can we close this issue?" Every closed item must comply — otherwise it was wrongly closed and must be reopened.*

- Analysis & design updated
- Code committed with proper message
- Unit tests developed and passing
- Functional tests performed & recorded

## Sprint Retrospective

*"Everyone did the best job they could, given what they knew at the time."*
*— Norm Kerth*

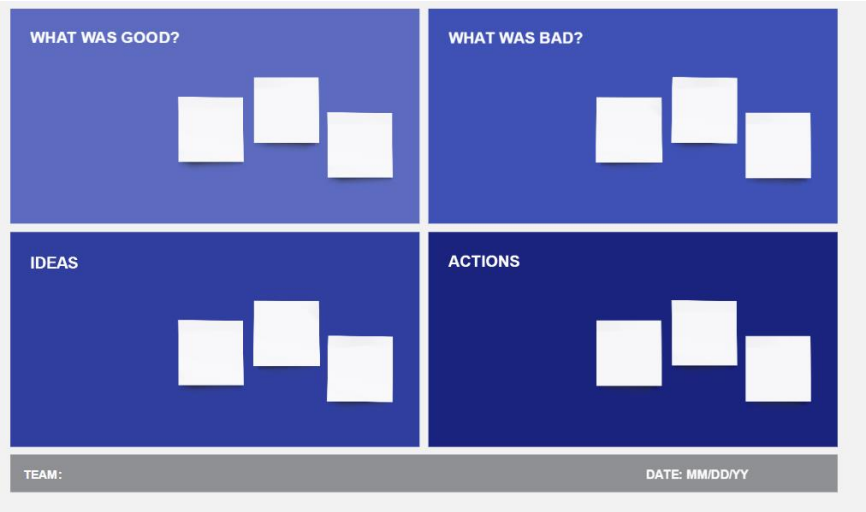
**Continuous-improvement question:**

*"How can we, as a team, work even better next sprint?"*

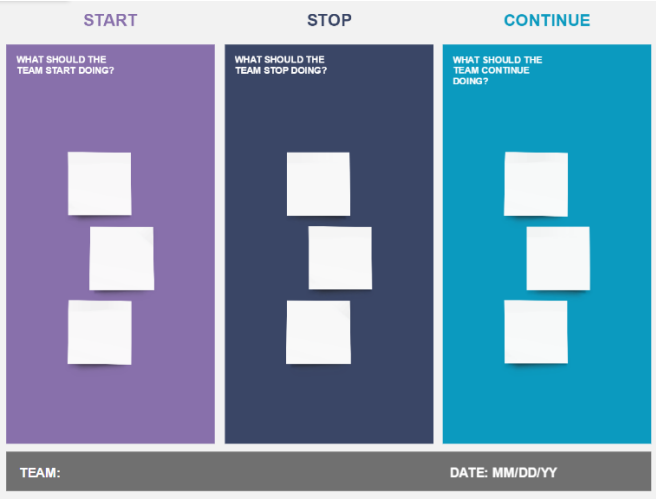
Formats: What Went Well / To Improve · Start / Stop / Continue

# SPRINT RETROSPECTIVE

## Wen Well/To Improve




## Start/Stop/Continue




https://www.atlassian.com/blog/jira-software/5-fun-sprint-retrospective-ideas-templates

# GIT AND SMART COMMITS

- Every commit must reference a ticket
- Use smart commits for traceability and automated workflow
- Pull frequently
- Commit frequently
- Do not commit broken code
- Always test before pushing
- Push frequently

# SOFTWARE ENGINEERING PROCESS

- Keep in mind that every “thing” is part of a software project and must follow the software engineering process
  - Even if it is not “exactly” programming in “Java”

- Analisys → Design → Test plan → Code → Test execution

- Provide evidences that the process has been followed

# WALKING SKELETON

*A Walking Skeleton is a tiny implementation of the system that performs a small end-to-end function. It need not use the final architecture, but it should link together the main architectural components. The architecture and the functionality can then evolve in parallel.*

- Alistair Cockburn

# EXAMPLE WALKING SKELETON

## Scenario A

- Basic UI form with no input fields, just one button that sends a DTO to the backend with just one atribute. The backend persists the data without any business logic validation
- Future slices increment functionality by adding more attributes and child objects and business rules

## Scenario B

- Basic UI form with just one button that calls a Controller method using some fixed parameters. The Controller uses a Proxy to call a remote service with a simple DTO and expects a simple DTO in return. The proxy has no failure handling habilities. The data received by the controller and the remote service is passed to the Repository for persistence.
- Future slices increment functionality such as failure handling and retry on the Proxy as well as additional attributes and business logic

# READINGS


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